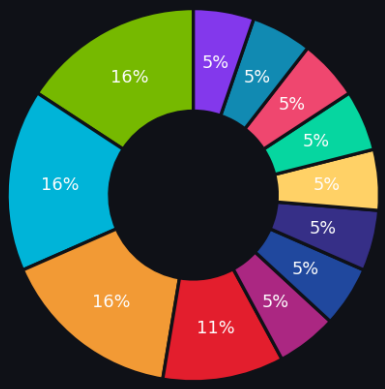
F5 Daily Briefing – Wednesday, October 28, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

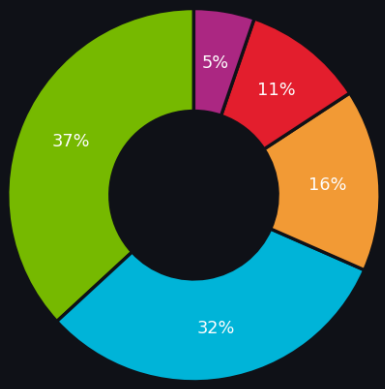
22	19	12	5
COMPETITORS TRACKED	ANNOUNCEMENTS	ACTIVE	ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



- Cisco (3)
- CrowdStrike (3)
- AWS (3)
- Palo Alto Networks (2)
- Fortinet (1)
- Zscaler (1)
- Check Point Software (1)
- Cloudflare (1)
- HiddenLayer (1)
- Citrix (NetScaler) (1)
- Arista Networks (1)
- Radware (1)

Announcements by Category



- AI Security (7)
- Platforms (6)
- Application Delivery (ADCs) (3)
- AI Data Delivery (2)
- Application Security (1)

ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (19)

Product Launch | Palo Alto Networks | Platforms | Wed, Oct 28, 2026

Palo Alto Networks Launches Cortex Cloud SaaS Security

Palo Alto Networks extended Cortex Cloud to bring SaaS and cloud security into one view, covering posture, identity, data and AI security. A central dashboard covers about 100 SaaS apps and keeps checking them for misconfigurations, risky integrations and compliance gaps. It links context across SaaS and cloud to find active and dormant AI agents and possible attack paths, and uses Cortex AgentiX AI workflows to speed up investigation and fixes. The company cites Unit 42 data showing 87% of attacks span multiple surfaces.

Source: https://www.paloaltonetworks.com/blog/cloud-security/introducing-cortex-cloud-saas-security/

Feature Update | Palo Alto Networks | Platforms | Wed, Oct 28, 2026

Palo Alto Networks Releases More PAN-OS Hotfixes for PHP2Shell Vulnerabilities

On October 28, Palo Alto Networks released three more hotfixes for the critical PHP2Shell remote-code-execution flaws (CVE-2026-109618/109619), which affect the PAN-OS and Panorama management interfaces. More fixes are scheduled for October 29-30. Until then, customers are told to limit management access to trusted internal IPs. PANW shares dipped about 0.7%.

Source: https://www.gurufocus.com/news/9147780/palo-alto-networks-stocks-move-lower-with-more-php2shell-fixes-released

Financial Fortinet Platforms Wed, Oct 28, 2026

Fortinet Reports Q3 2026 Results, Raises Full-Year Guidance

Q3 revenue rose 20% to $2.08B, product revenue rose 37% to $765M and billings rose 29% to $2.34B. Fortinet raised FY2026 guidance to $8.125B-$8.215B in revenue and added $1.2B to its buyback authorization. It highlighted FortiGuard Inline AI Security Service, FortiLink SASE and AI security work with NVIDIA, Oracle (FortiAIGate) and Microsoft. Even so, shares fell about 25% after hours over concerns about service-revenue growth and margins.

Source: https://www.fortinet.com/corporate/about-us/newsroom/press-releases/2026/fortinet-reports-third-quarter-2026-financial-results

Feature Update Cisco Platforms Wed, Oct 28, 2026

Cisco Adds MCP Servers and Agent Access Controls to Networking Platforms

heise reports on Cisco's Partner Summit 2026 networking announcements. New standard MCP servers let outside AI tools and agents read configuration and telemetry from Meraki, Catalyst Center and ISE. ThousandEyes testing is now built into Wi-Fi 6E/7 access points. Privileged Infrastructure Access gives admins and AI agents time-limited, task-based access with short-lived certificates.

Source: https://www.heise.de/en/news/Cisco-Manage-networks-through-MCP-11503237.html

Product Launch Cisco AI Security Wed, Oct 28, 2026

Cisco Open-Sources Project Quarry for Detecting Multi-Step AI Agent Attacks

Quarry is an open-source rule language and engine. It combines ML classifiers and LLM judges with exact rule checks to spot multi-step agent attacks across LLM conversations, tool use, MCP calls and multimodal inputs. Each match comes with evidence and can trigger an alert, block, redaction or quarantine. Cisco is building Quarry into Cisco AI Defense and DefenseClaw and plans to send its findings to Splunk.

Source: https://blogs.cisco.com/ai/project-quarry-agent-security-detections

Partnership Cisco AI Security Wed, Oct 28, 2026

Cisco AI Defense Joins ServiceNow's Control Tower Alliance as Founding Member

Cisco AI Defense is now a founding member of ServiceNow's Control Tower Alliance. It brings AI asset discovery, supply-chain risk checks, AI red-teaming and runtime protection for models, agents, datasets and MCP servers into ServiceNow's AI governance platform. Two integrations are already in the ServiceNow Store, sending AI Defense inventory and detections into ServiceNow AI Security Exposure Management.

Source: https://blogs.cisco.com/ai/cisco-ai-defense-joins-servicenows-control-tower-alliance

Research CrowdStrike Platforms Wed, Oct 28, 2026

CrowdStrike 2026 Legal Threat Landscape Report: Cybercriminals Blur Digital and Physical Lines

CrowdStrike's report says 82% of malicious activity against U.S. law firms is financially motivated. CHATTY SPIDER activity rose 129%, including recruiting people to physically get into firms. Extortion listings rose 39% to 455 legal entities. SNARKY SPIDER and CORDIAL SPIDER are abusing SaaS identities, and China-linked groups stepped up espionage. CrowdStrike argues for unified visibility across identity, endpoint and cloud.

Source: https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20261028008406/en/CrowdStrike-2026-Legal-Threat-Landscape-Report-Cybercriminals-Blur-Digital-and-Physical-Lines-in-Attacks-on-U.S.-Law-Firms

Research CrowdStrike AI Security Wed, Oct 28, 2026

CrowdStrike Research: When AI Guardrails Expose Vulnerabilities

CrowdStrike researchers introduced Guardrail-based Vulnerability Discovery (GbVD), which treats an AI model's guardrail refusals on code as signals that point to real vulnerabilities. In tests on a C web server across five vulnerability classes, it found the issue in 73 of 86 scenarios. The researchers note attackers could use the same signals.

Source: https://www.crowdstrike.com/en-us/blog/when-ai-guardrails-expose-vulnerabilities/

Research CrowdStrike AI Security Wed, Oct 28, 2026

CrowdStrike Reveals Autonomous AI Agents Used in Attacks on Brazilian Government Entities

CrowdStrike studied four previously unreported groups using autonomous, multi-agent AI to run intrusions in Latin America, including against Brazilian government bodies and Argentine healthcare organizations. In one case an agent reached a domain controller in about 20 minutes. The attackers' most effective method was persuading the AI it was running an authorized penetration test. CrowdStrike reports AI-driven intrusions tripled in H2 2026 versus H1.

Source: https://www.tiinside.com.br/en/28/10/2026/crowdstrike-revela-uso-de-agentes-de-ia-para-ataques-a-entidades-governamentais-no-brasil/

Event Zscaler AI Security Wed, Oct 28, 2026

Zscaler Keynote at ONUG Fall 2026: Zero Trust in the Age of AI

At ONUG Fall 2026 on October 28, Zscaler Global VP and CXO in Residence George Moser gave an industry keynote. He argued that zero trust architecture is what separates AI-ready enterprises, because it protects AI workloads and data pipelines as attackers use AI. The talk supports Zscaler's message that its Zero Trust platform is the foundation for AI security.

Source: https://onug.net/events/zero-trust-in-the-age-of-ai-why-architecture-matters-industry-leader-keynote/

Product Launch Check Point Software Platforms Wed, Oct 28, 2026

Check Point Launches Firewall-as-a-Subscription for AI-Era Network Protection

Check Point launched Firewall-as-a-Subscription. It bundles Force firewalls, the R82.20 AI Network Firewall, SandBlast threat prevention, Live Updates, Smart-1 Agentic Management, and premium support into one monthly or annual fee. The three-year term has no upfront hardware cost, allows throughput upgrades at any time, and includes a hardware refresh after 36 months. It is sold through partners starting November 1, 2026, positioned against flat security budgets and growing AI traffic.

Source: https://www.mynewsdesk.com/se/checkpoint/pressreleases/check-point-lanserar-brandvaegg-paa-prenumeration-ska-goera-avancerat-skydd-i-ai-eran-tillgaengligt-foer-alla-verksamheter-3474898

Feature Update Cloudflare Application Delivery (ADCs) Wed, Oct 28, 2026

Cloudflare Opens Quicksilver to Customers as Workers KV Instant

Cloudflare released Quicksilver, its internal config-distribution store, to customers as a new Workers KV mode called KV Instant. It offers p99 reads of 1.62 ms across 300 edge locations, and writes replicate in about 107 ms (median). Each namespace is capped at 10,000 keys and 1 MB, with one write per second, and pricing differs from Classic KV. KV Instant is in private beta with no general availability date.

Source: https://www.infoq.com/news/2026/10/workers-kv-instant/

Product Launch AWS AI Data Delivery Wed, Oct 28, 2026

Amazon Bedrock AgentCore CLI 1.0 Generally Available

AWS released version 1.0 of the Amazon Bedrock AgentCore CLI as generally available. The rebuilt tool creates, develops, deploys, and runs AI agents from the terminal. It works directly with harnesses, runtimes, memory, identity, gateways, and payments, and can invoke resources by ID or ARN. It adds an interactive shell, guided workflows, and consistent global flags. Existing projects can move over with 'agentcore migrate'.

Source: https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/10/amazon-bedrock-agentcore-cli-version-1-0-available/

Feature Update AWS AI Security Wed, Oct 28, 2026

Amazon Quick Adds Smart Approvals for Agentic Actions

Amazon Quick now uses a classifier to approve routine agent actions automatically, such as sending email or updating records. Higher-impact actions go to the user for review, including permission changes, payments, deletions, and anything beyond what the user intended. Existing policies still apply and no new access is granted. The feature is on by default, admins can configure it, and all reviews and policy changes are logged in CloudTrail.

Source: https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/10/quick-smart-approvals-agentic-actions/

Feature Update | AWS | Application Delivery (ADCs) | Wed, Oct 28, 2026

Amazon EKS Auto Mode Now Supports Kubernetes Gateway API

EKS Auto Mode now supports the Kubernetes Gateway API, so teams can configure application load balancing with Gateway and HTTPRoute resources and no extra controllers. It supports HTTP and gRPC routing, cross-namespace traffic, weighted splitting, header-based routing, and automatic TLS certificate discovery through AWS Certificate Manager. Existing Ingress workloads keep working, and standard AWS load balancer charges apply.

Source: https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/10/amazon-eks-auto-mode-kubernetes-gateway-api/

Partnership | HiddenLayer | AI Security | Wed, Oct 28, 2026

HiddenLayer Joins ServiceNow AI Control Tower Alliance as Founding Member

HiddenLayer joined ServiceNow's new Control Tower Alliance as a founding member. It will add AI security to ServiceNow's Super Intelligence Control Tower across discovery, supply chain security, runtime protection and governance, with a focus on agentic threats. Other founding members include Anthropic, AWS, Cisco, OpenAI, NVIDIA and Okta, and the alliance plans pre-integrated, certified solutions and joint go-to-market work.

Source: https://www.hiddenlayer.com/news/hiddenlayer-servicenow-control-tower-alliance

Feature Update | Citrix (NetScaler) | Application Delivery (ADCs) | Wed, Oct 28, 2026

Citrix Lists NetScaler ADC/Gateway Builds Fixing Exploited PHP2Shell Flaws (CVE-2026-109618/109619)

Citrix updated its bulletin to list fixed NetScaler ADC and Gateway builds for the PHP2Shell flaws: 14.1-73.49+, 13.1-64.32+, and matching FIPS/NDcPP builds. CISA added the CVEs to its Known Exploited Vulnerabilities catalog on Oct 26, and Citrix urges customer-managed deployments to upgrade immediately. This follows NetScaler zero-day patch rounds in September and October 2026.

Source: https://www.defenderdaily.com/stories/2026/10/netscaler-builds-fix-php2shell-flaws

Customer | Arista Networks | AI Data Delivery | Wed, Oct 28, 2026

Meta Taps Arista 7800 and Broadcom Jericho3 to Stitch Together Prometheus AI Supercluster

Meta disclosed that its Prometheus AI supercluster uses Arista 7800-series chassis with Broadcom Jericho3 silicon as the aggregation layer. This layer links GPU buildings across distances of 2 km to over 100 km, using 800G-ZR optics on the longer links. It shows Arista's role in multi-site AI training networks beyond the GPU rack. No contract value was disclosed.

Source: https://www.sdxcentral.com/news/meta-taps-arista-and-broadcom-jericho3-to-stitch-prometheus-supercluster-together/

Financial | Radware | Application Security | Wed, Oct 28, 2026

Radware Reports Record Q3 2026 Revenue of $84.4M; Cloud ARR Up 21%

Radware posted record Q3 2026 revenue of $84.4M, up 12% year over year, with Cloud ARR up 21% to $107M. Non-GAAP diluted EPS was $0.32 and GAAP EPS $0.11, with every region growing about 12%. CEO Roy Zisapel cited strong demand for application security, growth in its cloud security platform and new AI security capabilities.

Source: https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2026/10/28/3389938/8980/en/radware-reports-third-quarter-2026-financial-results.html